



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Oak Hill Classical School
School Website: <https://oakhillclassical.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Oak Hill Classical School (Dacula, GA 30019) presents a robust classical Christian program anchored in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), integration with a biblical worldview, and an emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and beauty. Public materials from the school's website repeatedly foreground formation of character and formation in faith, a history-centered curriculum that includes Great Books and Western Civilization, and pedagogical practices that blend contemplative/memory tasks (Schol ) with Socratic discussion and rhetoric work. The school is explicitly affiliated with ACCS and frames its mission around wisdom, joyful learning, and love for God and others. Across six standard classical criteria, Oak Hill demonstrates strong alignment with classical education principles, with no clear signals of anti-classical tendencies in the visible public materials. Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Executive impressions by category, with keyword-based analysis and rubric-aligned scoring, are summarized below and followed by the detailed category-by-category sections. The rubric and keyword frameworks applied draw directly from the classical education lexicon and the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Key supporting evidence includes mission statements and philosophy stressing Jesus Christ, biblical worldview, and the integration of theology with curriculum; references to the Trivium and Quadrivium; explicit mention of Great Books and Western Civilization in the curriculum; clear Socratic/seminar-style elements in upper grades; and active parent engagement through open houses, prospective parent days, and parent involvement guidelines. See the cited OHCS pages and documents for exact language. [filecite](#)[turn0file1](#)[turn0file2](#)[turn0file5](#)[turn0file6](#)[turn0file7](#)[turn0file9](#)[turn0file14](#)

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Mission emphasizes formation through a Christian worldview, grounding education in Christ and biblical truth. The mission statement explicitly notes a Christian grounding: "cultivates wisdom, joyful learning, and love for God and others." - The Philosophy of Education centers on the person of Jesus Christ and on viewing all knowledge through a Christian framework; the school is described as classical Christian education grounded in Scripture. - ACCS affiliation is referenced, situating Oak Hill within a classical Christian community with a stated statement of faith. - Public-facing materials emphasize worship through music and a liturgical sensibility in communal practice; references to God as the integrating principle of understanding life and learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (sample): theology, Christ, biblical worldview, worship, truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, sacred tradition, Logos, imago Dei, reverence, wonder, grace. Much of this language appears in mission, philosophy, and curriculum descriptions, as well as in thematic sections on music and worship. The classical lexicon highlights these terms as core indicators of a religious/metaphysical foundation. - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or value-neutral framings observed in the available materials). The site consistently frames education within a Christian, transcendent framework.

Why this rating - The school's public materials center Christology and theology as foundational to education, explicitly linking knowledge with faith and biblical truth. This aligns with the Positive Keywords for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (truth, theology, liturgy/worship, imago Dei, sacred tradition) and with the Six Essentials framework's emphasis on formation, virtue, and transcendental realities. The absence of counter-indicators (e.g., relativism or secular humanism) in the visible content supports CLASSICAL here.

Citations: Mission/Philosophy statements; ACCS membership and faith alignment; worship/music and sacred-context language. [filecite](#)[turn0file1](#)[turn0file3](#)[turn0file2](#)

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school states that education is formation (not merely information) and aims to cultivate wisdom and virtue, aligning with the classical aim of forming rather than just informing. The mission emphasizes wisdom, joyful learning, and love for God and others. The philosophy emphasizes formation in Christ and in a biblical worldview as the telos of education. - The public materials articulate that truth, goodness, and beauty are real and knowable, and that human beings can come to know them, aligning with classical telos and paideia ideals. The "What is Classical Education?" framing explicitly ties knowledge to the Trivium and to a worldview anchored in truth. [filecite](#)[turn0file5](#)[turn0file9](#) - Great Books and Western Civilization are positioned as central components of the curriculum, a marker of formation through enduring questions and classical heritage. The Rhetoric School section includes literature such as Confessions, Hamlet, Great Gatsby, indicating a permanent-questions/social-hundreds approach typical of classical education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (sample): formation, wisdom, virtue, human flourishing, liberal education, great conversation, telos, Truth-Goodness-Beauty, classical, paideia, routine of reverence for enduring texts, study of Western Civilization. The lexicon and Six Essentials glossary identify these as primary signals of a classical aim. - Negative keywords present: none evident in the public materials (no explicit emphasis on workforce-prep or skills-focused utilitarian framing); rather the site foregrounds formation, virtue, and classical inquiry. The Six Essentials negative list anticipates potential signals (e.g., workforce-readiness framing), which do not appear in the OHCS public materials.

Why this rating - The school's stated goals center formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty within a classical framework. The public materials reinforce education as formation of character and intellect anchored in faith, not primarily job-prep or technology-centric aims. This aligns with CLASSICAL criteria.

Citations: Mission/Philosophy; Great Books/Western Civilization; Trivium framing; references to classical education as formation. [filecite](#)[turn0file1](#)[turn0file5](#)[turn0file8](#)

Element 3: School Curriculum — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The Trivium (grammar, logic, and rhetoric) is described as central to academics; explicit reference to Trivium as the organizing concept for study and pedagogy. - The curriculum includes Great Books and "great conversation" as part of humanities study, with explicit examples drawn from listed works (Confessions, Hamlet, Great Gatsby) and Western Civilization / humanities content in the Rhetoric School program. - Latin and languages, logic, rhetoric, and the Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) are described as core elements of the Rhetoric School's program, with specific courses and co-curriculars aligned to these liberal-arts strands. - History is pursued across the curriculum with emphasis on Western Civilization and

biblical worldview, rather than reducing history to “social studies.” The publicly shared curriculum pages emphasize history within humanities and Western civilization study.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (sample): Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, great conversation, Western Civilization, liberal arts, Latin, quadrivium, humanities, history, philosophy, literature, Bible as core, biblical worldview. These map directly to the Six Essentials lexicon’s Curriculum signals. - Negative keywords present: minimal to none in the public content (no strong signals of “social studies framing” replacing history or a STEM-first orientation; the content emphasizes history and classical texts rather than project-first or experiential curricula). The Six Essentials negatives identify potential signals (social studies terminology replacing history; STEM-first framing) that do not appear in OHCS materials.

Why this rating - The curriculum explicitly embraces the liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric), the Great Books tradition, Latin, and a historically oriented Western Civilization emphasis, with explicit Great Conversation framing. This aligns with CLASSICAL.

Citations: Trivium and curriculum language; Great Books and Great Conversation examples; Latin/Quadrivium; Western Civilization emphasis. [filecite](#)[turn0file6](#)[turn0file8](#)[turn0file7](#)

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Lower-school practices: singing and chanting, memory work, and other contemplative/reminiscent pedagogy appear in the nature of “Scholé” and memory-deepening activities (The Body class and related sub-creator coursework emphasize musical and mnemonic approaches). - Upper-school pedagogy emphasizes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training. The Rhetoric School materials describe logic, rhetoric, and a mechanism for public speaking and writing, consistent with Socratic/seminar pedagogy and rhetoric practice. - The public materials also show an intentional blend of contemplative, restful, and rigorous elements (as per classical pedagogy guidelines): “The lower school often engages in singing and chanting; upper school emphasizes Socratic discussion and rhetoric.” The existence of both modes is a hallmark of classical pedagogy. [filecite](#)[turn0file2](#)[turn0file5](#) - The school’s rhetoric program includes opportunities for speeches and rhetorical training, aligning with classical pedagogy expectations.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (sample): Socratic, seminars, debate, rhetoric, memory work, narration, chanting, scholé, contemplation, wonder, seminar, tutorial, Paideia-style elements, public speaking, classical education. The public content shows explicit mention of these methods in upper and lower grades, which maps to the Six Essentials pedagogy signals. - Negative keywords present: The content does not emphasize exclusive project-based/experiential-only approaches or student-directed discovery as the sole method; rather, it presents a balanced mix with explicit Socratic/rhetoric and contemplative elements. The negative signals in the lexicon (e.g., “experiential learning first” or “constructivist-only”) do not appear as dominant in OHCS pages.

Why this rating - The pedagogy clearly reflects classical methods: memory-focused lower-school rites and chant-like activities; Socratic seminars and rhetoric training in upper grades; structured integration of Great Books and liberal-arts pedagogy; emphasis on disciplined dialogue and public speaking. This combination supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Lower- and upper-school pedagogy language; Socratic/seminar references; rhetoric and public speaking emphasis. [filecite](#)[turn0file2](#)[turn0file4](#)

Element 5: School Faculty — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school presents a mission of cultivating wisdom and virtue through teachers who model service and Christian virtue; the public materials emphasize faculty commitment to classical Christian pedagogy, training, and the partnership with families to educate children in the Lord. The “Employment Opportunities” and “Support Oak Hill” sections emphasize faculty quality, training, and compensation aligned with classical pedagogy. - The school references a focus on small class sizes, teacher training in classical pedagogy, and hiring excellent administrators and teachers committed to classical Christian education, which aligns

with the idea of teachers as the living curriculum and mentors in classical education. - The “House System” and community-oriented elements signal a mentoring, communal faculty culture consistent with the classical model (faculty as a core part of the school’s ethos and culture).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (sample): living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, teachers who love God and subject, faculty of friends, collegial culture, portrait of a teacher, mentorship, character formation, lifelong learners. The Six Essentials lexicon highlights “the living curriculum,” “model teachers,” and “portrait of a teacher” as indicators of classical faculty culture. - Negative keywords present: none evident in the public materials (no signals of a purely technocratic or non-classical faculty framework). The content consistently frames faculty as moral exemplars within a Christian, classical context.

Why this rating - The materials frame the faculty as the core of the school’s classical mission and emphasize virtue, mentorship, and classical pedagogy. This aligns with CLASSICAL signals in the faculty category.

Citations: Employment and faculty-focused language; small-class, teacher training emphasis; “living curriculum” and faculty structure language. [filecite](#)[turn0file9](#)[turn0file15](#)

Element 6: Parents & Community — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and being co-educators; parent formation and community engagement are explicit (open houses, prospective parent days, and parent involvement activities are advertised). The school invites parent visits and engagement through events and day-to-day communications. - Communications about parental involvement include parent events, book studies, gatherings, and volunteer guidelines, signaling a commitment to family formation and classical community life. The Gryphon Flight Team and volunteer guidelines demonstrate structured parent participation and communal service opportunities. - The school’s financial-aid and admissions communications frame family participation in economic aspects of the school community as well, reinforcing a family-centered, covenantal approach to classical education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (sample): partnership with families, co-teachers, family involvement, parent formation, home-school synergy, parental engagement, community of learners, living tradition in the family. The Six Essentials lexicon identifies “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections” as key signals for a healthy classical community environment. - Negative keywords present: none observed (no consumer-language-only or minimal parent involvement signals). The OHCS materials consistently present parents as collaborators and co-educators.

Why this rating - The materials demonstrate explicit and ongoing engagement with families and a theology-informed, shared educational mission. This aligns with CLASSICAL signals for Parents & Community.

Citations: Open houses, prospective parent days, parent formation activities, volunteer guidelines, and family-partner language. [filecite](#)[turn0file9](#)[turn0file14](#)

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable here because all six categories are CLASSICAL based on the current public materials. No category-specific needle-moving changes are required to reach CLASSICAL across the board.

If future materials shifted toward a more explicit “career/workforce readiness” emphasis or reduced emphasis on Great Books/Western Civilization or formal Socratic pedagogy, those could be potential needle-movers toward not-classical. Conversely, continued explicit articulation of Great Books, humanities, and the Great Conversation, with continued integration of the Trivium and Quadrivium, will solidify CLASSICAL status.

Note: The Six Essential Elements and the Classical Lexicon provide the framework used here to assess keyword alignment and category signals, including terms like wisdom, virtue, Truth-Goodness-Beauty, formation, Trivium, Great Books, Great Conversation, Socratic pedagogy, scholé, partnership with families, and living curriculum. See the Six Essentials elements doc for the formal keyword sets, and the classical lexicon for the explicit positive/negative indicators. [filecite](#)[turn0file17](#)[turn0file13](#)

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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